Rich, slightly nutty avocado works well with arugula. Hass avocados are particularly good, but always buy extra in case one turns out to be blemished.

avocado and arugula soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS PLUS 1 HR CHILLING **COOK** NONE **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

3 large (or 4 medium) ripe avocados
juice of 1 lemon
5½oz (150g) wild arugula
3¼ cups cold chicken or vegetable stock
¼ tsp harissa
salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 Peel the avocados and remove their pits, then chop the flesh and put it in a blender or food processor with the lemon juice. Coarsely chop the arugula (save a few sprigs to decorate) and add to the avocado mixture. Pour in the stock. Add the harissa and season with salt and pepper, then blend until smooth. Transfer to a bowl, cover and refrigerate for 1 hour.

2 Before serving, taste and adjust the seasoning. Pour into bowls or glasses, add an ice cube or two to each and decorate with sprigs of arugula. Serve chilled.